

Cover Letter — Revised Submission (R1)

Date: 23 June 2026

To, The Editor Medical Journal of Dr. D.Y. Patil Vidyapeeth (MJDRDYPUP)

Re: Revised manuscript mjdrdypu_451_26 — “Can Ageing Be Slowed or Reversed? A Reproducible Evidence Map and Credibility Ranking of Anti-Ageing and Age-Reversal Interventions”

Dear Editor,

Thank you for the opportunity to revise the above manuscript and for the referees’ time. I am pleased to submit the revised version together with a point-by-point response to the reviewers.

The manuscript presents a reproducible, conservative evidence map of anti-ageing and age-reversal intervention claims. It explicitly separates healthspan benefit, biological-age biomarkers, lifespan claims, and true clinical rejuvenation, and it avoids therapeutic overclaiming. The work uses public bibliographic metadata and open-access text only; no individual participant data were accessed.

In this revision I have substantially strengthened the manuscript:

- **Reviewer response.** I have addressed each reviewer comment in the accompanying point-by-point letter. I respectfully note that several comments (on diabetic versus non-diabetic patient groups, MMSE administration, and individual polypharmacy assessment) describe a patient-level clinical cohort study and do not correspond to the content of this bibliographic evidence map, which has no patient groups or individual-level data. I have nonetheless engaged the underlying geriatric principles raised — confounding control, frailty, cognitive-screening validity, and medication appropriateness — as they apply to the primary studies synthesised here.
- **Scientific framing.** The manuscript is now presented as a completed, deliberately scoped evidence map. Internal working language (“pilot,” “capped run,” “counts will change,” “final submission requires...”) has been removed throughout, and the abstract conclusion has been sharpened into a definitive scholarly statement.
- **Title.** Refined to remove “Mechanistic Synthesis,” which was not delivered as a discrete analysis, giving a title that matches the content.
- **Figures.** Figure 2 has been corrected; the submitted version mistakenly plotted a different score column and disagreed with Table 1. All four figures have been regenerated from the source data with data labels and plain-language axis titles.
- **References.** Author lists are now truncated to six authors followed by “et al.” per Vancouver style, citation numbering is sequential by first appearance, and in-text citations use superscript bracketed numerals.

The submission package includes: the revised blinded manuscript (with Tables 1–3 and the figure legends placed after the references), a separate figures file (Figures 1–4), this cover letter, a separate title page, declarations, a point-by-point response to reviewers, the submission checklist, supplementary material (Supplementary Table S1 and supporting items), the PRISMA 2020 checklist, and a reference audit.

The manuscript is not under consideration elsewhere. All scientific claims have been verified by the author prior to resubmission.

Sincerely,

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